

C: Language change

The focus of this section is on the analysis of historical varieties of English. The analysis will be based on drawing connections and comparisons between two texts from different times.

Learners should study the ways that the English language has developed and changed over time, including methodologies for the study of language change.

Learners should study a range of historical texts and genres. They are expected to be able to identify and compare significant features or patterns in texts from two different times and to explore their effects.

Learners should be able to analyse language features in a range of contexts, comparing and contrasting the possible effects of contextual factors on the way language is produced in each text and is received and understood by their audiences.

- show knowledge and understanding of the language levels including:
 - **phonetics, phonology and prosodics:** how speech sounds and effects are articulated and analysed
 - **lexis and semantics:** the vocabulary of English, including social and historical variation
 - **grammar, including morphology:** the structural patterns and shapes of English at sentence, clause, phrase and word level
 - **pragmatics:** the contextual aspects of language use
 - **discourse:** extended stretches of communication occurring in different genres, modes and contexts
- show knowledge and understanding of how the language levels (above) can be applied to a range of contexts for language use, including historical varieties of English
- understand how the different areas of study connect across their course as a whole
- apply language concepts and methods of analysis appropriately and systematically to data
- explore connections across different texts and discourses